

The interior shell, built right the first time.

Specialist interior fit-out and drywall, self-delivered for Tier-1 main contractors in the UAE. Built on a team that has worked in this trade since 1986.

One accountable team for the whole interior.

EDM Holdings is a specialist drywall and interior fit-out contractor. We self-deliver the trades that make up the inside of a building — partitions, ceilings, timber, glazing, joinery and finishes — so a main contractor has one team to manage instead of a string of subcontractors.

Most fit-out packages are split across several trades. Every split is an interface, and every interface is where programme, quality and accountability tend to slip. We take those interfaces off your critical path by putting them inside our own scope. One contract, one team on site, one standard from the first wall to the final snag.

In the UAE we contract through EDM Technical Services L.L.C, our Dubai-licensed delivery entity, wholly owned by EDM Consultant FZCO. Our workforce is fully scalable, European led and European managed — directly employed, directly supervised, and currently live on site on a thirteen-zone mission-critical package for a Tier-1 main contractor.

Self-delivered

Directly employed and managed labour from start to finish. The standard doesn't change hands halfway through the job.

Accountable

One company owns the package end to end. When something needs answering, a real person who knows the job picks up — the same working day.

Proven

Four decades of delivered interiors behind the people in this business, carried over from their E&D Drywall heritage and live on site in the UAE today.

Every split in a package is an interface. Every interface is a risk you carry.

A typical interior package is let to four or five specialists. Partitions to one, ceilings to another, joinery, glazing and decoration to three more. Each is competent. Each holds a different programme, a different quality plan and a different view of where their scope ends.

The gaps between them are where projects lose time. A ceiling grid set out before the partition line is confirmed. A glazed screen ordered to a dimension that moved. Fire-stopping that belongs to whoever was there last. None of these appear on a tender comparison, and all of them land on the main contractor's desk as a coordination problem nobody priced.

We price the whole interior and install it with our own people, so the interfaces sit inside one contract rather than between five.

One programme	Sequencing between trades is an internal scheduling matter for us, not a negotiation between subcontractors with different incentives. When boarding has to wait for services, the same supervisor moves the crew somewhere useful.
One quality plan	The same inspection stages, the same tolerances and the same sign-off discipline apply from setting out to final decoration. The standard doesn't change hands halfway through the floor.
One point of responsibility	There is no interface argument to referee, because there is nobody to argue with. If something in the interior is wrong, it is ours.
One set of records	Wall references, inspection records, photographs and handover files are produced by one system rather than assembled from four suppliers at the end.
One commercial conversation	A single valuation, a single variation account and a single final account for the whole interior package.

Self-delivery costs more on paper than the cheapest combination of subcontract prices. It costs less by handover, because the money a split package loses is spent on coordination, rework and delay, and none of it is visible when the tender is compared.

The trades that make the inside of a building.



Drywall partitions & ceilings

Metal-stud partitions, shaft walls, MF and suspended ceilings, dry lining and encasements — set out right and built square the first time.



Fire & acoustic-rated systems

Built to the certified detail and documented as we go, so they stand up to inspection at handover — and to diligence afterwards.



Timber wall & ceiling panels

Veneered and slatted finishes, acoustic-backed where required, for the feature areas that carry the scheme.



Aluminium & glazing

Single and double-glazed partition systems, framed or frameless, to open up the floorplate without giving up acoustic performance.



Painting & decoration

Commercial-grade paint and decorative finishes to a defined, handover-ready level — agreed up front, not argued at the end.



Joinery

Reception counters, tea points, storage and feature joinery, made to drawing and fitted by the same team that built the walls around it.

Every trade above is delivered under EDM supervision to one programme, one quality plan and one point of responsibility.

The details that decide whether a package is easy or expensive.

Drywall looks like a simple trade from a distance. Most of the cost risk in it sits in five details, and they are all decided before anyone starts boarding.

Setting out

Every line is set from a survey of what was actually built, not from the architectural drawing alone. Structures move, slabs are poured out of tolerance and existing buildings are never what the record says. Half a day proving the grid at the start prevents a floor of walls being three millimetres out against joinery that was made to drawing.

Head-of-wall detail

Partitions are rigid; slabs deflect under load, thermally and over time. If the head detail does not allow for the movement the structural design predicts, the board cracks along the top or the studs take load they were never designed to carry. The deflection head is installed to the certified detail, with the right gap and the right fixing centres, and fire-stopped to the tested arrangement rather than the convenient one.

Fire-stopping and penetrations

The least visible work in the package and the most consequential. The right product, in the right gap, to the tested arrangement, at every point a service crosses a compartment line. Photographed and signed before it is covered, because the only way to verify it afterwards is to cut into the wall.

Risers and shaft walls

Where drywall and services have their argument. Most risers can only be built from one side, which changes the system, the sequence and the access. On paper there is always room, because on paper nothing has a bracket, an insulation thickness or an installation tolerance. We want riser sections coordinated at pre-construction, not discovered when the first duct arrives.

Acoustic continuity

A specified partition performs at the junctions, not in the middle of the panel. A well-built acoustic wall with an open ceiling void above the line performs about as well as a doorway. The same applies to glazed screens, where the head channel, the floor detail and the void above decide the result rather than the glass specification.

None of this is unusual knowledge. It is simply what a firm learns by being wrong on a live job, and it is priced into what an experienced contractor quotes.

Four sectors, and what each one demands.

The trades are the same everywhere. What changes is the tolerance, the inspection regime, the working environment and the consequence of a delay.

Workplace

Cat A and Cat B.
Grade-A floors
where the finish is
the product and
the seam between
landlord and
tenant scope is
where cost hides.

Residential

Repetition at
volume. Output
rates, consistent
detailing and unit-
by-unit sign-off
matter more than
any single feature.

Hotels & leisure

Acoustic
separation
between keys,
heavy feature
finishes and a
handover date that
is usually tied to a
trading opening.

Education

Fixed holiday
windows, hard-
wearing detailing
built for use, and
compliance
documentation
that gets read
rather than filed.

Mission-critical work sets the ceiling. A firm that can hold data-centre inspection discipline can hold it comfortably on a commercial floor. It rarely transfers the other way.

Our current UAE delivery is a thirteen-zone mission-critical package. Data centre work is documented, witnessed and closed in sequence, and nothing is covered on a promise. That regime is the reason our inspection and handover standard looks the way it does, and every other sector benefits from it.

Scale

Packages from single-floor fit-outs to multi-zone programmes running in sequence. The workforce is directly employed and scales with the package rather than being assembled per project.

Environments

New build, refurbishment, occupied buildings and live operational facilities, including permit-controlled areas with restricted access and out-of-hours working.

Procurement routes

Traditional lump sum, two-stage, and negotiated package appointments as a specialist partner to the main contractor.

Live now: a mission-critical interior package.

Our newest package sits inside a 100MW data centre in the UAE, delivered as subcontractor to a Tier-1 main contractor. It is mission-critical work, where the tolerances are tighter, the inspections harder and the programme less forgiving than any commercial fit-out.

The works are structured across thirteen zones, each built, inspected and handed over in sequence so the wider programme keeps moving while we deliver. Zone-by-zone handovers are under way.

WHY IT MATTERS TO A MAIN CONTRACTOR

Data centre delivery proves the disciplines a Tier-1 buys from a package partner: certified fire details installed and documented, zoned handovers held against a fixed programme, and daily coordination with the trades working around us.

Thirteen zones

Delivered and handed over sequentially, with each zone inspected and closed out before the team moves on.

Mission-critical

Drywall and fit-out built to data-centre tolerances and documented to the certified standard.

Live now

Crews on site today under EDM supervision, reporting daily to the main contractor.

Client and project references are available on request, subject to client consent.

Controlled on site, proven on paper.

Every EDM package runs on the same controls, on every site. Method statements, risk assessments and material approvals are signed off before work starts. Operatives are inducted, directly supervised and briefed at daily toolbox talks. Stage inspections run against agreed inspection and test plans, with fire and acoustic details recorded at the point they're closed in — not reconstructed at the end.

Directly employed

Inducted, supervised and briefed daily, on every site. We know who is on the floor because they work for us.

European led

European-managed supervision and a workforce that scales with the package.

Evidenced

Full HSE documentation, insurances and records set out in our PQQ information pack, available on request.

THE HANDOVER STANDARD

Every zone is left to our published Handover Standard, with a complete handover file — inspection records, certifications and close-out documentation — so nothing is chased after the crews have gone.

Before work starts

Method statements, risk assessments and approvals submitted and signed off in advance.

While we build

Inducted, directly supervised teams, daily toolbox talks and permit discipline in live environments.

At handover

Zoned handover files complete on the day — records, certifications and close-out in one place.

Four systems, built in-house, that follow one wall from tender to handover.

Most subcontractors price on one system, build on another and report on a third, and none of them talk to each other. When a main contractor asks how complete a level is, the answer comes from a walk-round and a feeling.

We built our own tools instead, because the thread between pricing, building, proving and reporting is where the commercial value sits. The reference a wall gets at tender stage is the reference it keeps through construction and into the handover file.

01 • PRICE IT

EDM Measure

Drawing-based takeoff. The drawing is calibrated, then each wall run is traced and lands in a live, priced bill against a wall reference. No scaling by eye, no re-typing.

A wall-type library carries real build-ups — single and double layer, acoustic, shaft wall, linings — with supply and labour rates behind them, so a price is a build-up rather than a rate per square metre.

Revision overlay: load the new revision over the old, and what changed is highlighted. The variation is measured before anyone argues about whether there is one.

02 • PROVE IT

EDM Evidence

The wall register arrives from the takeoff with the same references. Every wall then runs through eight inspection stages — setting out, framing, services closed in, insulation, each layer of board, fire-stopping, decoration — signed, dated and initialled by the supervisor who looked at it.

The two stages that matter will not accept a pass without a photograph. No wall is boarded without a picture of the services inside it; no fire-stopping is signed off without a picture of the seal.

Failed checks stay on the record beside the passes. That is what makes a pass worth something.

The same wall register, carried through to the report and the daily record.

Progress and Daybook close the loop. One turns signed inspections into the client report; the other captures what happened on the day, including the instructions that decide the final account.

03 • REPORT IT

EDM Progress

The same wall register, with dates against it. Planned stage dates by zone form the programme; actual progress fills itself in from what the supervisors have already signed, so there is no double entry and no optimism.

Percentage complete comes from signed inspections rather than a walk-round, which is why our numbers stop needing revision.

Delay log: hold-ups are logged the day they happen — access, preceding trade, RFI — and closed out when they clear. Months later that dated log is the extension-of-time conversation.

04 • RECORD IT

EDM Daybook

One page a day on the site manager's phone. Labour by trade, weather, deliveries, snags — and every instruction received, with who gave it, what they said, the time, and a photograph if there is something to see.

Verbal instructions are where subcontractors lose money. Logged in ten seconds on the day, an instruction becomes something the QS can turn into a priced variation instead of a disagreement about what was said in March.

The printed record states that instructions listed are notice of change, with formal confirmation to follow. That protects both parties.

WHAT THE THREAD MEANS COMMERCIALLY

Pricing, inspection, programme and the daily record all point at the same wall reference. So a valuation, a progress figure and a variation can each be traced back to a record made at the time.

At valuation

The measure is a record, not an opinion. A re-measure becomes a comparison of two documents.

At variation

The instruction, the date and the revision that changed are on file before the work is done — when a change is cheapest for everyone.

At handover

The pack is a by-product of how the work was built. When a question arrives two years later, it is a search rather than an opening-up exercise.

Evidence, not promises.

The riskiest moment in any drywall package is the day a wall is boarded over. Once it is closed, nobody can see what is behind it, and years later somebody has to prove what was built. We decided that proof should be part of the product rather than an extra.

1 Every wall has a number

Assigned at tender stage in the takeoff, and kept through construction and into the handover file. The wall we priced, the wall we built and the wall we are claiming for are provably the same wall.

2 Every stage is inspected and signed

Setting out, framing, services closed in, insulation, each layer of board, fire-stopping, decoration. Checked in sequence, dated and initialled by the supervisor who looked at it — not marked complete by whoever was nearest.

3 Photographed before it disappears

No wall is boarded over without a photograph of the services inside it, and no fire-stopping is signed off without a picture of the seal. The record will not accept a pass without the photograph.

4 Handed over as a pack, not a promise

At completion — or at each zone, where the works are zoned — you receive the full record: every wall, every check, every photograph, as a single document your team can file, audit and rely on.

WHY IT MATTERS TO A MAIN CONTRACTOR

Fire-safety regulation increasingly expects a traceable thread of building information, and interior walls are where that thread most often breaks. A complete record for the interior package means fewer opening-up exercises, faster sign-off at handover, and an answer on file when the question arrives years later.

What it costs you

Nothing. It is how we work. The systems are ours, built in-house, and they travel with every EDM package as standard.

What we ask of you

Agree the inspection and test plan and the benchmark standard early, so the record measures the right things against a standard both parties have signed.

A good drywall price is mostly good reading.

When a drawing package arrives, the number is the last thing we work out. First come the questions. Every one is free at tender stage and costs weeks if it is found in week nine on site.

1 Does the head detail survive the predicted deflection?

Cross-checked against the structural information rather than assumed from the partition schedule.

2 Do the fire strategy and the partition schedule tell the same story?

One is frequently revised without the other. The difference is a compartment line in the wrong place, found at inspection.

3 Is there physically room in the riser walls?

For the services drawn through them, with brackets, insulation and installation tolerance included.

4 Is the ceiling void deep enough for everything at once?

Grid, services, fire-stopping and access, together — not each in isolation.

5 What does the access actually allow?

Hoists, working hours, permit regimes and occupied-building restrictions decide real output rates more than any labour constant.

A tender that comes back with questions is worth more than one that comes back only with a number.

What we return

A priced package built from wall build-ups rather than a rate per square metre, a labour build-up we can produce in ten minutes, the assumptions we have priced on, and the qualifications that matter — nothing hidden in a covering letter.

Turnaround

An acknowledgement and a first read the same working day, with a view on whether anything in the pack is going to cause a problem.

Commercial conduct

Changes raised when they occur, not at final account. Instructions logged the day. Valuations supported by the same records as the programme, so the measure is not a matter of opinion.

What the first two weeks look like.

Most of what determines whether a package runs well happens before the first stud goes up.

Week one — set up

Method statements, risk assessments and material approvals submitted and signed off before work starts. Wall reference plan printed and posted in the site cabin so everyone — our supervisor, the main contractor's engineer, a visiting consultant — can see what is built, what is inspected and what is waiting. Inspection and test plan agreed. Benchmark panel programmed.

Week one — verify

Setting out taken from a survey of the as-built structure, not from drawings alone. Riser and ceiling void coordination walked with the services trades and the sequence agreed out loud, then written down.

Week two — benchmark

One area built and signed off by the client and the main contractor as the agreed level of finish, joint and lighting condition. Twenty minutes in week two that removes the argument that otherwise surfaces at handover when the cost of changing anything is at its highest.

Then — rhythm

Daily toolbox talks that say what has changed on this floor, who is working above, where the new penetration is and what the permit covers. Weekly report on a fixed day. Snags closed as we go while the trades are still on the floor and the access is still up.

REPORTING

A weekly client report covering progress by zone against plan, anything behind, a two-week lookahead and the open delay log. The percentage in it comes from signed inspection records, so it does not need revising later.

Escalation

If a date is at risk, you hear it from us while there is still something anyone can do about it.

The workforce is not a cost line. It is the product.

In a self-delivery business, everything a client is buying arrives on site in a van. Which is why our labour is directly employed rather than brokered through a chain of suppliers with our logo on the hoarding.

Directly employing costs more on paper. It buys three things that are difficult to obtain any other way.

Known outputs. We have measured the same crews over years, so the programme we sign up to is one we have genuinely resourced rather than one we hope to achieve at a market rate.

A standard that holds. The team that boards a wall works to the same brief as the team that framed it. Quality is not the standard of the best wall on the job; it is the standard of the four hundredth, built on a Thursday afternoon by a

crew who are behind. That is set by supervision, not by intent.

Answers from someone who was there. When a question arrives about a detail on Level 4, it goes to the supervisor who signed it off, not down a chain to a supplier who has demobilised.

Supervision is European led and European managed. The workforce scales with the package rather than being assembled for it, and crews who have worked together for years self-correct — somebody notices the setting out is off before the third wall goes up.

Supervision

Working supervisors on the floor, not managing from an office. Every stage sign-off carries the initials of the person who inspected it.

Induction and briefing

Every operative inducted, directly supervised and briefed daily. Specific to the floor and the day, not a signature sheet.

Continuity

The same people move between packages, which is how the standard travels and how the estimating stays honest.

A record that survives diligence.

Four sectors: residential, workplace, hotels and leisure, and education. Eleven delivered schemes across the UK and Ireland behind the people in this business, and live delivery in the UAE today on a thirteen-zone mission-critical package.

Turnover, audited accounts, insurance limits and package-specific references are set out in our PQQ information pack, available on request.

Delivery in the UAE. Experience behind it.

UAE

DELIVERY

Ireland

TRACK RECORD

United Kingdom

TRACK RECORD

Australia

GROUP INTEREST

We contract and deliver in the UAE through EDM Technical Services L.L.C. The delivered track record behind this team was built in the UK and Ireland, and it is the reason our supervision, our inspection regime and our handover standard look the way they do. We mobilise into a market only when we can hold the same standard there.

What onboarding looks like from your side.

Most of a pre-qualification exercise is chasing. Ours is assembled and ready, and we will provide it in whatever format your supply chain system needs rather than sending a folder and hoping.

Documentation held	Trade licence and company registration, insurances, health and safety policy, RAMS templates, quality plan, the published handover standard, and references relevant to the sector you are asking about.
Commercial information	Turnover, audited accounts and insurance limits are provided in the PQQ pack rather than published, so you receive figures alongside the documents that support them.
References	Package-specific references on request. Where a client requires consent before being named, we ask them first — including for our current UAE delivery.
Contracting entity	In the UAE we contract through EDM Technical Services L.L.C, our Dubai-licensed delivery entity, wholly owned by EDM Consultant FZCO.

Send us the drawings and the programme, and you will get a straight answer the same working day.

Enquiries	Christopher Simon, Chief Operating Officer · enquiries@edmholdings.ae · +971 (0) 58 601 2021
What helps most	Drawings, the programme, and the date you need a price by. If there is a fire strategy and a partition schedule, send those too.

A package partner to Tier-1 contractors.

We work as a specialist interior package partner to Tier-1 main contractors and consultancies, including:

JLL

Gilbert-Ash

Graham

John Sisk & Son

McLaughlin & Harvey

Farrans

Four people, and what each of them owns.

A specialist subcontractor is a small number of people making the same decisions consistently. These are ours.



CHAIRMAN

Eddie Duffy

Co-founder and Chairman, setting strategic direction across the group. Eddie's focus is growth that holds, long-term client relationships and the quality of what actually gets built in the UAE. Four decades in specialist interiors, and the view that a contractor should own the whole interior rather than a slice of it.



CHIEF EXECUTIVE
OFFICER

Damien Meenan

Co-founder and Chief Executive, running the business day to day, with a remit spanning the group's interests in Dubai, Ireland, Australia and London. Twenty-five years in the trade, and the holder of the two commitments the model depends on: directly employed labour, and a record of the work made as it is built.



CHIEF OPERATING
OFFICER

**Christopher
Simon**

Chief Operating Officer, responsible for EDM's operations in the Middle East and the named contact for tender and pre-qualification enquiries. Over twenty-two years in senior commercial property and operations roles in London and Dubai, which is why he reads a package as a date, a number and a risk before it is a wall.



PROJECT DIRECTOR

**Kenny
Buchanan**

Twenty years in interior fit-out, drywall and every trade EDM self-delivers, on projects in Ireland, London, the UAE and Australia. That time on site shapes how the team plans a package and holds it to programme.

Enquiries about tenders, pre-qualification and package pricing go to Christopher Simon — enquiries@edmholdings.ae, +971 (0) 58 601 2021.

Send us the drawings and the programme.

You will get an acknowledgement and a first read the same working day, including a view on whether anything in the pack is going to cause a problem later.

Christopher Simon · Chief Operating Officer

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edmholdings.ae

What helps most

Drawings, the programme, and the date you need a price by. If there is a fire strategy and a partition schedule, send those too.

Also available

Corporate brochure, handover standard and PQQ information pack, on request or from edmholdings.ae.

Contracting entity

EDM Technical Services L.L.C, Dubai, wholly owned by EDM Consultant FZCO.

The interior shell, built right the first time.
